Hyun Soo Suh

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Education

University of Chicago 2026 – 2027

- Visitor in Residence, Center for the Economics of Human Development

Washington University in St. Louis 2021 –

- Ph.D. in Economics 2027 (Expected)
- M.A. in Economics 2023

Boston University 2019 – 2020

- M.A. in Economics *MA Prize of Academic Excellence*

Korea University 2015 – 2019

- B.A. in Economics & B.A. in French Language and Literature *Great Honor*

Sciences Po Fall 2017

- Exchange Student in Economics *Le Certificat en Sciences Sociales et Humanités*

Research

Job Market Paper

- Who Gains from Maternal Employment? Self-Employment, Childcare, and Child Development

Abstract: Whether a mother's employment helps or harms her child depends on how well formal childcare substitutes for her time. I estimate a household life-cycle model of work arrangements, time, and child skill formation on UK panel data, and find that this substitutability differs by education. Using the paid-versus-self-employment margin, I decompose a work arrangement into three attributes: flexibility, earnings level, and earnings volatility. Fathers' time responds little to a young child, so mothers are the sole margin of adjustment. A college-educated mother's time is her child's most productive input, which formal care substitutes for poorly, while for a non-college mother it substitutes well. Full-time employment therefore lowers a child's skills by 0.14 to 0.19 SD when the mother is college educated but has little effect when she is not. Flexible hours without a pay penalty raise maternal employment by about 4 percentage points and increase household welfare, while leaving child skills essentially unchanged, because mothers substitute leisure for work and maintain time with the child. Childcare raises skills mainly for non-college children, so tagging it by education targets the gains. Pairing the two policies benefits both groups and raises the projected lifetime earnings of children of non-college mothers by about 2.5%.

Publications

- Beyond Time and Money: Parental Occupation and Early Childhood Development
  AEA Papers and Proceedings, 116: 605–610.

Working Papers

- Female Micro-Entrepreneurship and Child Development (with Andrew Foster and Moritz Poll) [NBER WP]
- Mental Health and the Early Career Dynamics of Young Men (with Cecilia Diaz-Campo, Barton Hamilton, and Martin Luccioni)

Work in Progress

- Sorting on Gains: The STEM Gender Gap in Jamaica (with George-Levi Gayle, Peter-John Gordon, Nadine McCloud-Rose, Rana Mohie Eldin, and Ismaël Mourifié)
- Dynamic School Choice with Unknown Priorities (with George-Levi Gayle, Peter-John Gordon, Laura Hurtado-Moreno, Nadine McCloud-Rose, and Rana Mohie Eldin)

Updated: October 2026

- Are Schools Equalizers or Amplifiers? School Value Added After a Randomized Anti-Poverty Program (with Moritz Poll)
- Two Readings of One Child: Grit, Perceived Ability, and Household Investment

Awards & Grants

- Weiss Fund Research Grant *$24,953; with Moritz Poll* 2026 – 2028
- J-PAL Learning for All Initiative Grant *$74,800; with Moritz Poll* 2025 – 2026
- J-PAL Gender and Economic Agency Initiative Grant *$49,696; with Moritz Poll* 2025 – 2026
- INED Visiting Ph.D. Fellowship Summer 2023
- Washington University in St. Louis Fellowship 2021 – Present
- Boston University Merit-Based Scholarship 2019 – 2020
- Boston University RA-Mentor Program Scholarship Spring 2020
- Boston University Manuel Abdala Grant for Fieldwork Spring 2020
- Boston University MA Prize of Academic Excellence Spring 2020
- Korea University Great Honor Fall 2019
- Korea University Semester High Honors 2015 – 2019

Research Experience

- **Washington University in St. Louis** RA to George-Lévi Gayle Fall 2022 – Present
- **Washington University in St. Louis** RA to Cecilia Diaz-Campo Fall 2023
- **World Bank** Short-Term Consultant Mar – Jun 2021
- **University of Pennsylvania** RA to Hans-Peter Kohler & Iliana Kohler Mar – Aug 2021
- **Boston University** RA to Yoonsook Ha Oct 2019 – Jul 2021
- **Boston University** RA to Mahesh Karra Oct 2019 – Jun 2020
- **Boston University** RA to Jordi Jaumandreu Oct 2019 – May 2020
- **INED** Internship Jan – Mar 2019

Teaching

Washington University in St. Louis

- Instructor: Introduction to Microeconomics [Syllabus] Summer 2025
- Instructor: Introduction to Stata [Syllabus] Spring 2024
- Assistant Instructor: Health Analytics (Spring 2026), Structural Microeconometrics - Graduate (Spring 2025), Microeconomics (Summer 2024), Industrial Organization (Fall 2022), Introduction to Microeconomics (Fall 2022)

Korea University

- Peer Tutor: Microeconomics Fall 2018

Conference Presentations († scheduled · ‡ by co-author)

- **2026** Allied Social Science Associations, West Indies Economic Conference, Midwest Economic Association‡, Centre for the Study of African Economies, North East Universities Gender Day, Population Association of America, Advances with Field Experiments, University of Pennsylvania, Center for the Economics of Human Development, WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference, Harris Public Policy PhD Workshop, Applied Young Economists' Webinar†, Harris Demography Workshop†, Behavior and Parenting Lab Workshop†, PhD Economics Virtual Seminar†
- **2025** Midwest Economic Association, WashU Applied Micro, Southeastern Health Economics Study Group Conference, WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference, Annual Health Econometrics Workshop‡, WashU Olin Brown Bag

- **2024** WashU Applied Micro, WashU Graduate Research Symposium (3rd prize, Social Sciences), WashU Olin Brown Bag, American Society of Health Economists

Professional Activities

Referee Annals of Economics and Statistics, Journal of Development Economics, Agricultural and Resource Economics Review, Studies in Family Planning

Service Washington University in St. Louis

- President, Graduate Student Association 2024 – 2025
- Member, Graduate Student Association 2022 – 2026
- Co-organizer, WashU Economics Graduate Student Conference (18th, 19th) 2023, 2024
- Co-organizer, WashU Job Market Jamboree (1st, 2nd) 2023, 2024
- Organizer, Applied Micro Research Group 2023 – 2024
- Co-organizer, Applied Metrics Study Group 2023 – 2024

Other Publications

- Socio-Economic Inequalities in Multidimensional Early Child Development: Evidence from France (with Lidia Panico and Anne Solaz)
  Population, Conditionally Accepted.
- Understanding Relations between State-Level Variation in TANF Spending and Substantiated Child Maltreatment in the USA (with Yoonsook Ha, Judith C. Scott, Mary Elizabeth Collins)
  Journal of Social Service Research, 48.4, 2022: 441–450.
- Embedding Financial Services in Frequented, Trusted Settings: Building on Families' Pre-existing Economic Mobility Efforts (with Savannah P. Alexander, Inhye Cellina Kim, Cyndie Hatcher, Yoonsook Ha, and Lucy E. Marcil)
  Journal of Developmental & Behavioral Pediatrics, 43.7, 2022: e442–451.
- Climate Change and Productivity of Northeastern Dairy Farms (with Rigoberto A. Lopez, Christopher Laughton, and Donghoon Kim)
  Agricultural and Resource Economics Review, 51.2, 2022: 203–221.

Skills

Programming Matlab, Julia, Stata, LaTeX, QGIS

Languages Korean (native), English (fluent), French (fluent), Spanish (intermediate), German (beginner)

References

Professor Barton H. Hamilton
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Washington University in St. Louis
Department of Economics
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